

What is a Computer?

A computer is a programmable electronic device. It follows a simple cycle: **Input** → **Process** → **Output**. [[1](#), [2](#)]

- . **Input:** Entering raw facts, numbers, or letters (using a keyboard or mouse).
- . **Process:** Working on or calculating the data (done by the CPU).

- . **Output:** Showing the final result (on a monitor or printer)

Four Main Parts of a Computer System

1. **Monitor (Screen):** Shows text, pictures, and videos like a television.
2. **CPU (Central Processing Unit):** The "brain" of the computer that

runs programs and controls all other parts.

3. **Keyboard:** A board with keys used to type words and numbers.

4. **Mouse:** A small hand-moved device used to point, click, and open items on the screen. [[1](#), [2](#), [3](#)]

Hardware vs. Software

. **Hardware:** The physical, touchable parts of a

computer (e.g., keyboard, mouse, monitor, hard drive).

- . **Software:** The programs and instructions that tell the hardware what work to do (e.g., Windows, macOS, games, paint apps). [[1](#), [2](#)]

Computer Memory (Quick Guide)

- . **RAM (Random Access Memory):** Temporary

workspace. It holds data only while the computer is turned on. When you turn off the computer, RAM clears out.

- **ROM (Read-Only Memory):**

Permanent startup instructions built into the computer that do not disappear when powered off.

- . **Storage (Hard Drive / SSD):** Long-term storage where your photos, documents, and apps stay saved even after you shut down